

Day 79 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Geography of India (5): The Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's largest under-construction hydropower project — the Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project — its location, capacity, and 2026 progress.

Q: Where is the Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project located, and on which river?

A: On the Subansiri River, at the border of Arunachal Pradesh and Assam — making it a North-East India hydropower project.

Q: What is the Subansiri Lower Project's total installed capacity, and how is it structured?

A: 2,000 MW total, comprising 8 units of 250 MW each. It is being implemented by NHPC Limited.

Q: What milestone did the project reach on 14 June 2026?

A: Successful 'boxing-up' of Unit 5 (250 MW), bringing the project's commissioned capacity to 1,250 MW across 5 units.

Q: When is the Subansiri Lower Project expected to be fully commissioned?

A: By December 2026, with the remaining units commissioned in a phased manner.

Q: How much electricity is the project expected to generate annually once complete?

A: About 7,422 million units annually.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Subansiri Lower Hydroelectric Project is located on the Subansiri River, at the border of Assam and:

A. Meghalaya

B. Arunachal Pradesh ✓

C. Nagaland

D. Sikkim

Explanation: Arunachal Pradesh. [easy, web-research]

2. The Subansiri Lower Project's total installed capacity is:

A. 1,000 MW

B. 1,500 MW

C. 2,000 MW ✓

D. 2,500 MW

Explanation: 2,000 MW (8 units of 250 MW each). [medium, web-research]

3. The Subansiri Lower Project is being implemented by:

A. NTPC

B. NHPC Limited ✓

C. SJVN

D. Tehri Hydro Development Corporation

Explanation: NHPC Limited. [medium, web-research]

4. As of 14 June 2026 (after Unit 5's completion), the project's commissioned capacity reached:

A. 750 MW

B. 1,000 MW

C. 1,250 MW ✓

D. 1,500 MW

Explanation: 1,250 MW across 5 units. [hard, web-research]

5. The Subansiri Lower Project is expected to be fully commissioned by:

A. August 2026

B. December 2026 ✓

C. March 2027

D. December 2027

Explanation: December 2026. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Alphanumeric Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Alphanumeric Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, combining letters and numbers in a single pattern. Real exam evidence (independently re-verified) shows three core techniques: letter-to-number position coding, variable-gap letter sequences, and fixed-shift word ciphers.

Q: Method — letter-to-number position coding: If ACEG is coded as 16, and DFGH is coded as 25, how would HIKM be coded?

A: Each letter is converted to its position in the alphabet (A=1, B=2, ... Z=26) and summed. ACEG: A=1, C=3, E=5, G=7, sum=16 ✓. DFGH: D=4, F=6, G=7, H=8, sum=25 ✓. Applying the same rule to HIKM: H=8, I=9, K=11, M=13, sum=8+9+11+13=41.

Q: Method — widening-gap letter sequence: Find the next letter: B, E, I, N, ?

A: Check the gaps between consecutive letters' positions: B(2)→E(5) is +3, E(5)→I(9) is +4, I(9)→N(14) is +5. The gap itself increases by 1 each time, so the next gap is +6: N(14)+6=20, which is T.

Q: Method — fixed-shift word coding (Caesar-cipher style): If ROAD is coded as URDG, how would SWAN be coded using the same rule?

A: Check the shift for each letter: R→U is +3, O→R is +3, A→D is +3, D→G is +3 — a uniform +3 shift applied to every letter. Applying the same +3 shift to SWAN: S→V, W→Z, A→D, N→Q, giving VZDQ.

Q: Method — two-interleaved-sequences letter pair: A pattern alternates first-letters increasing by a fixed gap and second-letters decreasing by the same gap (e.g., AZ, GT, MN, ?, YB). How do you solve it?

A: Track the two positions (first letter, second letter) as SEPARATE sequences. First letters: A(1), G(7), M(13) — increasing by 6 each time, so next is 19=S, then 25=Y (matches the given final term Y). Second letters: Z(26), T(20), N(14) — decreasing by 6 each time, so next is 8=H, then 2=B (matches the given final term B). So the missing term is S+H = 'SH'.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If BDFH is coded as 20 (sum of letter positions), what would CEGI be coded as using the same rule?

- A. 22
- B. 24 ✓**
- C. 26
- D. 28

Explanation: C=3, E=5, G=7, I=9, sum=24. (Check rule: B=2, D=4, F=6, H=8, sum=20 ✓ matches given.) [medium, authored]

2. Find the next letter in the sequence: C, F, J, O, ?

- A. S
- B. T
- C. U ✓**
- D. V

Explanation: Gaps: C(3)→F(6) is +3, F(6)→J(10) is +4, J(10)→O(15) is +5, so next gap is +6: O(15)+6=21=U. [medium, authored]

3. If PLAN is coded as SODQ using a fixed letter shift, how would TRIM be coded using the same rule?

- A. WULP ✓**
- B. WUKP
- C. VULP
- D. WULO

Explanation: Shift check: P→S, L→O, A→D, N→Q — a uniform +3 shift. Applying +3 to TRIM: T→W, R→U, I→L, M→P, giving WULP. [hard, authored]

4. In the sequence DY, IT, NO, ?, XE, the first letters increase and second letters decrease by a fixed gap. What is the missing term?

- A. SJ ✓**
- B. SI
- C. TJ
- D. RJ

Explanation: First letters: D(4), I(9), N(14) — gap +5, so next is 19=S, then 24=X (matches given X). Second letters: Y(25), T(20), O(15) — gap -5, so next is 10=J, then 5=E (matches given E). Missing term: SJ. [hard, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Verbs – Gerunds, Infinitives, and Participles

READING MATERIAL

Covers when to use a gerund (verb+ing as a noun) vs. an infinitive (to+verb) vs. a participle (verb+ing/ed as an adjective) — especially after specific verbs and prepositions, where only ONE form is grammatically correct.

Q: Real exam: which sentence correctly uses a gerund — 'He agreed to buy a computer' / 'To walk is a good exercise' / 'She is a singer and dancer' / 'I enjoy writing stories for children'?

A: 'I enjoy writing stories for children' — 'writing' is a gerund (verb+ing used as a noun, here the object of 'enjoy'). The others use an infinitive ('to buy', 'To walk') or no verbal at all.

Q: Real exam: 'I heard of his having gained a prize.' What type of verbal is 'having gained'?

A: Compound Gerund (a perfect/compound gerund form — 'having' + past participle — used to show the gerund's action happened BEFORE another point in time).

Q: Real exam: identify the participle in 'The barking dog kept the neighbours awake all night.'

A: Barking — a present participle used as an adjective, describing 'dog' (not a gerund here, since it modifies a noun rather than acting as one).

Q: Real exam: which has the correct infinitive — 'She is bold enough to take decisions' / 'She is bold enough in accepting challenges' / 'She is bold but afraid of snakes' / 'She is bold enough to taking decisions'?

A: 'She is bold enough to take decisions' — the infinitive must stay in its base form ('to take'), never 'to taking' (mixing infinitive 'to' with a gerund '-ing' ending is always wrong).

Q: Real exam: fill in the blank with the suitable Gerund form: '____ seemed foolish when decisive action was required.'

A: Waiting — a gerund used as the SUBJECT of the sentence (not 'to wait'/'to be wait', which would be infinitives/ungrammatical here).

Q: Real exam: 'Dancing bird' is a compound word formed by combining which 2 word types?

A: Gerund + Noun ('dancing' = gerund, 'bird' = noun) — the same pattern as 'Bleaching powder' (bleaching = gerund, powder = noun), confirmed in a separate real exam's compound-word matching question.

Q: Real exam: 'I stopped ____ to him.' Which form is correct — 'talking', 'to talk', or 'being talked'?

A: Talking (gerund) — 'stop + gerund' means to cease an ongoing action ('I stopped talking' = I was talking, then ceased). Note: 'stop + infinitive' ('I stopped to talk') would mean something different — pausing another activity IN ORDER TO talk.

Q: Real exam: 'He asked me in ____ this form.' Which form is correct — 'filling' or 'to fill'?

A: Filling (gerund) — required after the preposition 'in'. A general rule: a verb immediately after a preposition must take the gerund (-ing) form, never the infinitive.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the sentence where a gerund is used.

- A. He agreed to buy a computer.
- B. To walk is a good exercise.
- C. She is a singer and dancer.

D. I enjoy writing stories for children. ✓

Explanation: I enjoy writing stories for children. [medium, question-bank-2017]

2. "I heard of his having gained a prize." The underlined words form a:

- A. Gerund
- B. Compound Gerund ✓**
- C. Infinitive
- D. Participle

Explanation: Compound Gerund. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Identify the participle: "The barking dog kept the neighbours awake all night."

- A. barking ✓**
- B. the
- C. kept

D. awake

Explanation: barking. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. Which one of the following has a correct infinitive?

A. She is bold enough to take decisions. ✓

B. She is bold enough in accepting challenges.

C. She is bold but afraid of snakes.

D. She is bold enough to taking decisions.

Explanation: She is bold enough to take decisions. [medium, question-bank-2025]

5. Fill in the blank with the suitable Gerund form: " ____ seemed foolish when decisive action was required."

A. Wait

B. Waiting ✓

C. To wait

D. To be wait

Explanation: Waiting. [medium, question-bank-2022]

6. "Dancing bird" is a compound word formed by combining:

A. Noun + Adjective

B. Adjective + Gerund

C. Gerund + Noun ✓

D. Preposition + Noun

Explanation: Gerund + Noun. [medium, question-bank-2017]

7. "I stopped ____ to him."

A. talking ✓

B. to talk

C. being talked

D. talk

Explanation: talking (gerund after 'stopped'). [medium, question-bank-2024]

8. "He asked me in ____ this form."

A. fill

B. to fill

C. filling ✓

D. filled

Explanation: filling (gerund after preposition 'in'). [medium, question-bank-2022]